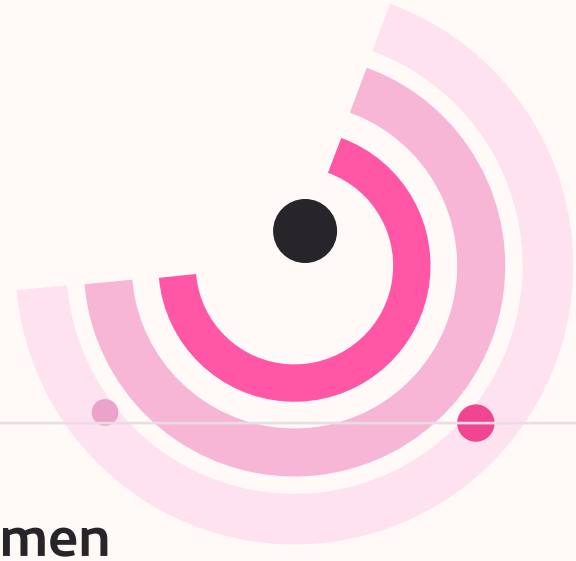
MENOPAUSE INDIA

YOUR FIRST GUIDE TO THE CHANGES OF MIDLIFE

MENOPAUSE 101



A simple guide for Indian women

Understand the changes. Know your options.
Feel more prepared.

Because no one should have to guess what is happening in her body.

A clear, practical place to begin, whether you are noticing changes or simply want to be prepared.

BY MENOPAUSE INDIA

READ IT. MARK IT. COME BACK TO IT.

THE BASICS

Three stages. One changing body.

The words sound similar, but each describes a different part of the journey.

01

PERIMENOPAUSE

THE LEAD-UP

Hormones begin to shift. Periods may come earlier or later, and symptoms can start while you are still menstruating.

02

MENOPAUSE

THE MILESTONE

12 months in a row without a period, when there is no other explanation. It is a milestone, not a year-long phase.

03

POSTMENOPAUSE

THE YEARS AFTER

The time after menopause. Some symptoms ease; others, such as vaginal dryness, can continue and deserve care.

There is no fixed timetable. Menopause often happens between 45 and 55, but may occur earlier. If your periods stop before 45, speak to a clinician.

On hormonal contraception or had surgery? Your doctor may use a different approach to work out your stage.

SPOT THE PATTERNS

Could these changes be menopause?

Tick what feels familiar. You do not need to experience all of these.

- [ ] Periods becoming less predictable
- [ ] Hot flushes or sudden warmth
- [ ] Night sweats
- [ ] Waking often at night
- [ ] Feeling unusually tired
- [ ] Mood changes or irritability
- [ ] Trouble focusing or remembering
- [ ] Joint or muscle aches
- [ ] Vaginal dryness or discomfort
- [ ] Needing to pee more often
- [ ] Changes in desire for intimacy
- [ ] Changes in skin or hair

WHAT HAVE YOU NOTICED MOST?

These changes can have other causes, too. A doctor can help assess what is happening, especially if symptoms are new or disruptive.

REAL LIFE

Does any of this sound familiar?

Sometimes changes show up in ordinary moments, not in a neat list of symptoms.

1

"I slept, so why am I exhausted?"

Night sweats or repeated waking may interrupt rest, even if you have spent enough time in bed.

2

"Why did I forget what I came here for?"

A new struggle to concentrate can be frustrating. Notice when it happens and whether it is changing.

3

"Is everyone else feeling this hot?"

A sudden rush of heat might appear during a commute, at work or in the middle of the night.

4

"Why are my periods all over the place?"

The timing or flow of periods can change. Bleeding that is unusually heavy still needs medical attention.

You deserve to understand what is changing. If a symptom is affecting your sleep, work, relationships or peace of mind, it is worth mentioning to a clinician.

EVERYDAY CARE

What can you actually do?

Start with one or two changes. There is no perfect routine you need to follow.

01

MAKE ROOM FOR SLEEP

Try consistent sleep and wake times. If night sweats keep waking you, ask about ways to treat them.

02

MOVE IN WAYS THAT FIT

Walking, dancing or yoga count. Add strength-building activity when you can, at a level that suits you.

03

EAT TO NOURISH YOURSELF

Include protein, vegetables and calcium-rich foods. Think dal, rajma, eggs, tofu, paneer or curd.

04

GIVE STRESS SOME SPACE

Notice what leaves you overwhelmed. Talk to someone you trust and make time for recovery.

WHEN SYMPTOMS AFFECT YOUR DAY

Ask about treatment options, including hormone therapy and non-hormonal care. What is suitable depends on your symptoms, preferences and medical history.

My one small step this week: _____

BE PREPARED

Take these questions to your doctor.

Your symptoms, period pattern and daily experience are useful information.

Before you go, note when changes began, what troubles you most, and any medicines or supplements you take.

- [ ] Could my symptoms be linked to perimenopause or menopause?
- [ ] Could something else explain them? Would any tests help?
- [ ] What can help my main symptom, and what are the benefits and risks?
- [ ] Might hormone therapy or a non-hormonal option suit me?
- [ ] What should I monitor, and when should we follow up?

A SIMPLE WAY TO START THE CONVERSATION

"The change bothering me most is _____ because it affects _____."

MY NOTES

REMEMBER THIS

Four things worth knowing.

You do not need to know everything before asking for help.

01

IT IS A NATURAL LIFE STAGE

Menopause is not an illness. Symptoms that interrupt your life still deserve proper care.

02

YOU CAN ASK FOR HELP EARLY

Symptoms can begin before periods stop. You do not have to wait to ask for help. Pregnancy can still happen during perimenopause.

03

CARE IS PERSONAL

Lifestyle support, hormone therapy or other treatments may be discussed. Your health history and preferences matter.

04

ONE TEST DOES NOT TELL THE STORY

For many women over 45, a clinician can use symptoms and period history rather than relying on a single hormone test.

WHEN TO GET CHECKED

Any vaginal bleeding after 12 months without a period needs medical assessment, even light spotting. Also discuss unusually heavy bleeding, a significant change in bleeding, or periods ending before age 45.

A PAGE TO KEEP

My next steps.

You can use this space now, or return to it before a doctor's appointment.

CHANGES I HAVE NOTICED

QUESTIONS I WANT TO ASK

ONE NEXT STEP I WILL TAKE

KEEP LEARNING WITH MENOPAUSE INDIA

Practical conversations with experts, plus a community that talks about these changes openly.

PODCAST + EXPERT TALKS

YouTube / @MenopauseIndia

Open link

THE COMMUNITY

Instagram / @menopauseindia

Open link

This guide is for education, not diagnosis or personalised medical advice. For your health concerns, consult a qualified clinician.

GUIDANCE: NHS NICE NG23 ACOG